Thus, by division method, $\sqrt{3}$ = 1.7320508…

It is found that the square root of every positive non perfect square number is an irrational number. $\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5}, \sqrt{6}, \sqrt{7}$, … are all irrational numbers.

Example 2.9 Classify the numbers as rational or irrational:

(i) $\sqrt{10}$ (ii) $\sqrt{49}$ (iii) 0.025 (iv) $0.7\overline{6}$ (v) 2.505500555... (vi) $\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}$

Solution

(i) $\sqrt{10}$ is an irrational number (since 10 is not a perfect square number).

(ii) $\sqrt{49} = 7 = \frac{7}{1}$, a rational number(since 49 is a perfect square number).

(iii) 0.025 is a rational number (since it is a terminating decimal).

(iv) $0.7\overline{6}$ = 0.7666…. is a rational number (since it is a non – terminating and recurring decimal expansion).

(v) 2.505500555…. is an irrational number (since it is a non – terminating and non–recurring decimal).

(vi) $\frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{2}\times\sqrt{2}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$ is an irrational number (since 2 is not a perfect square number).

Note

The above example(vi) it is not to be misunderstood as $\frac{p}{q}$ form, because both p and q must be integers and not an irrational number.

Example 2.10 Find any 3 irrational numbers between 0.12 and 0.13 .

Solution

Three irrational numbers between 0.12 and 0.13 are 0.12010010001…, 0.12040040004…, 0.12070070007…

Note

We state (without proof) an important result worth remembering.

If 'a' is a rational number and $\sqrt{b}$ is an irrational number then each one of the following is an irrational number:

(i) $a+\sqrt{b}$; (ii) $a-\sqrt{b}$; (iii) $a\sqrt{b}$; (iv) $\frac{a}{\sqrt{b}}$; (v) $\frac{\sqrt{b}}{a}$.

For example, when you consider the rational number 4 and the irrational number $\sqrt{5}$, then $4+\sqrt{5}$, $4-\sqrt{5}$, $4\sqrt{5}$, $\frac{4}{\sqrt{5}}$, $\frac{\sqrt{5}}{4}$ ... are all irrational numbers.

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